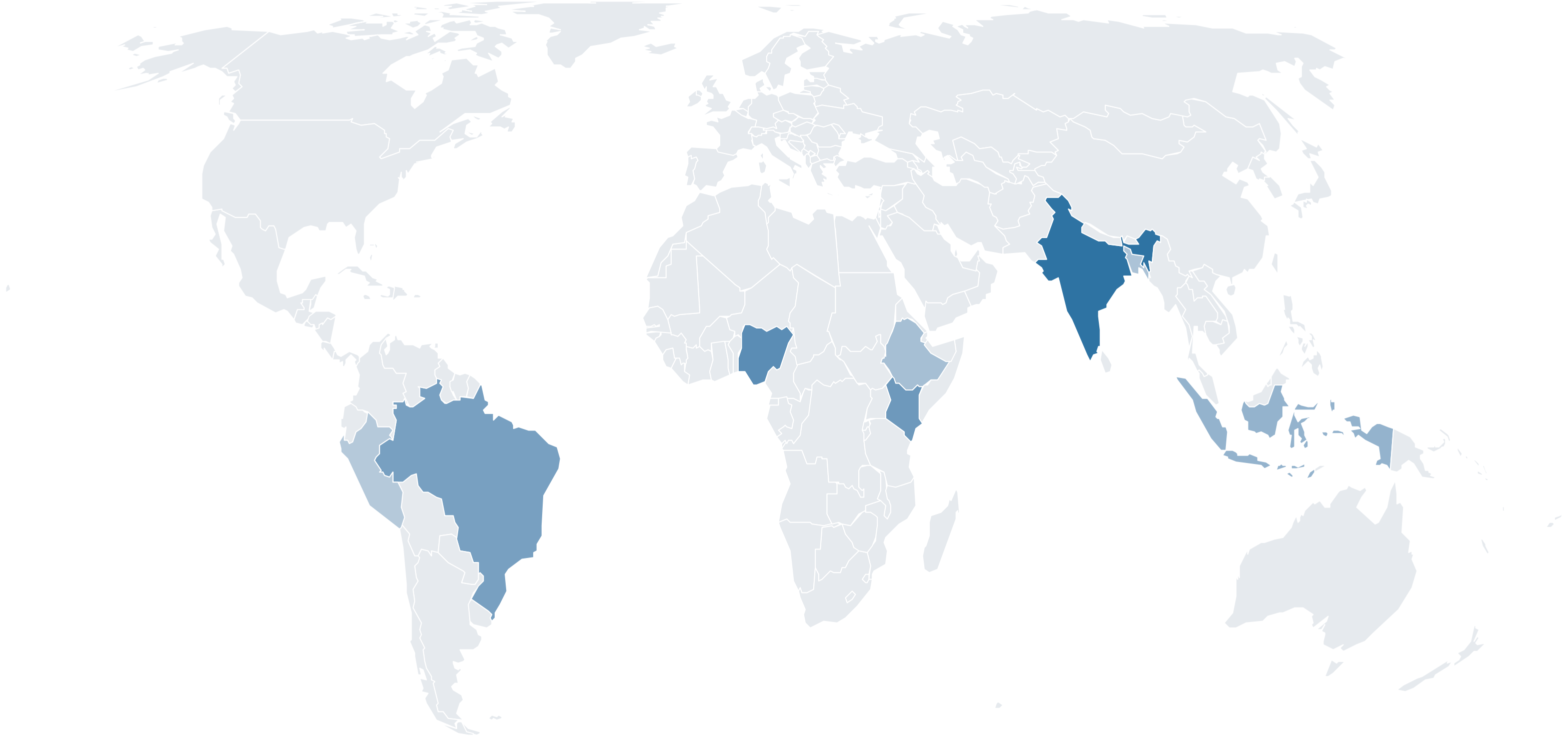
EVIDENCE · SPATIAL · SERIES

map

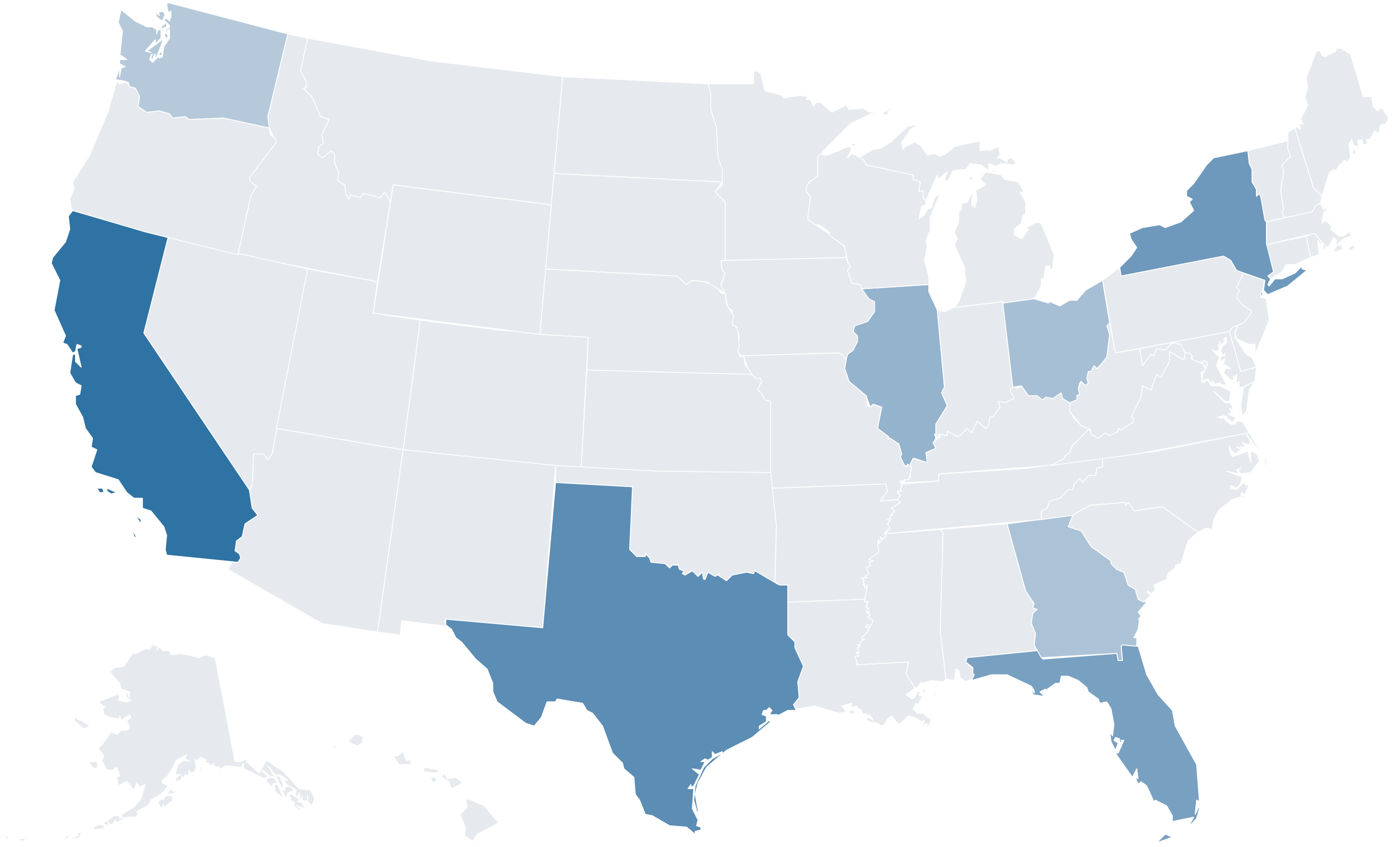
A world-countries (or US-states) basemap that fills regions by value (choropleth) or category (highlight) so the audience leaves knowing where.

The map fills regions by value.



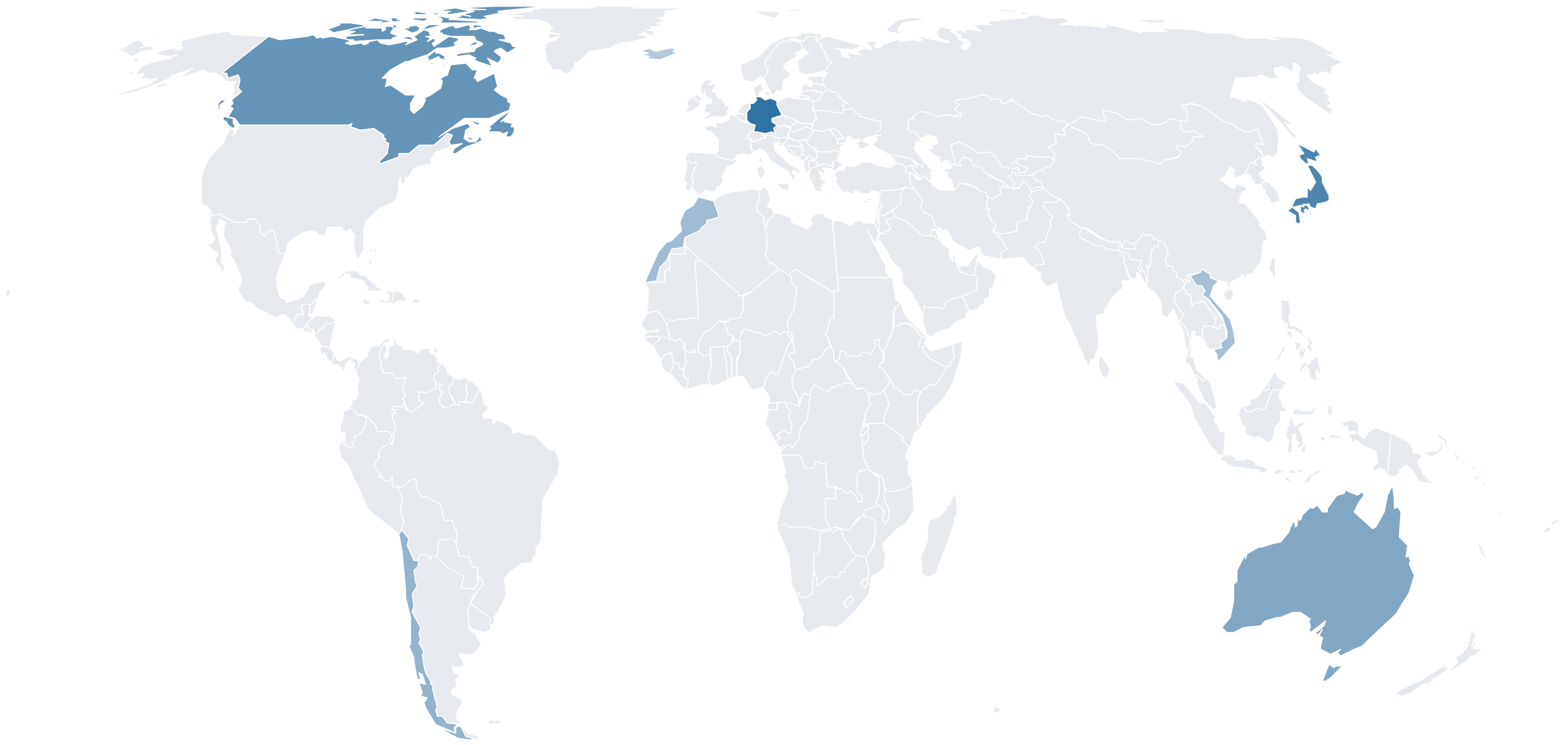
India	48.2
Nigeria	36.4
Kenya	31.0
Brazil	27.5
Indonesia	19.3
Ethiopia	14.1
Bangladesh	11.8
Peru	9.6

us swaps in the US-states basemap.



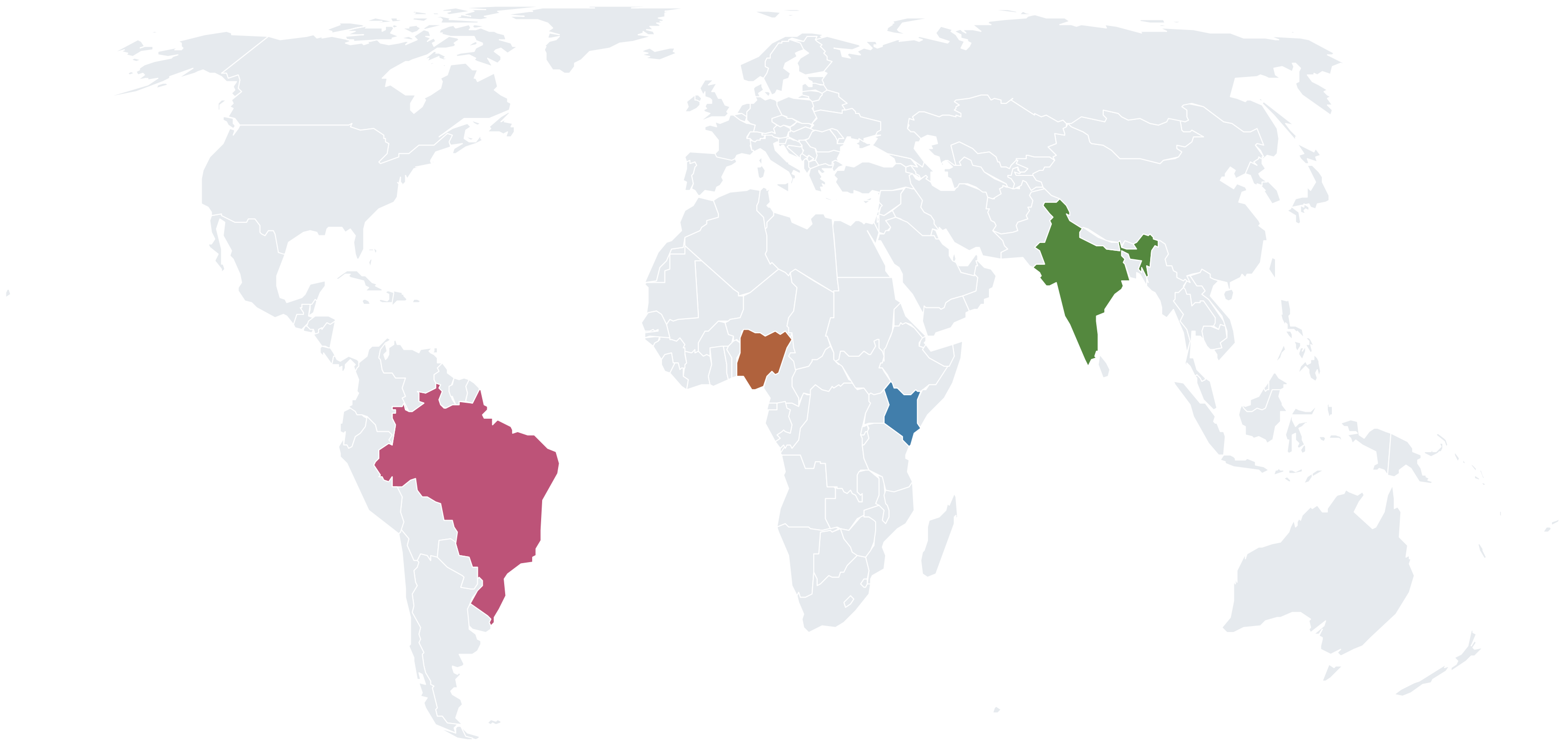
California	48.2
Texas	36.4
New York	31.0
Florida	27.5
Illinois	19.3
Ohio	14.1
Georgia	11.8
Washington	9.6

The same engine, pinned to the world basemap.



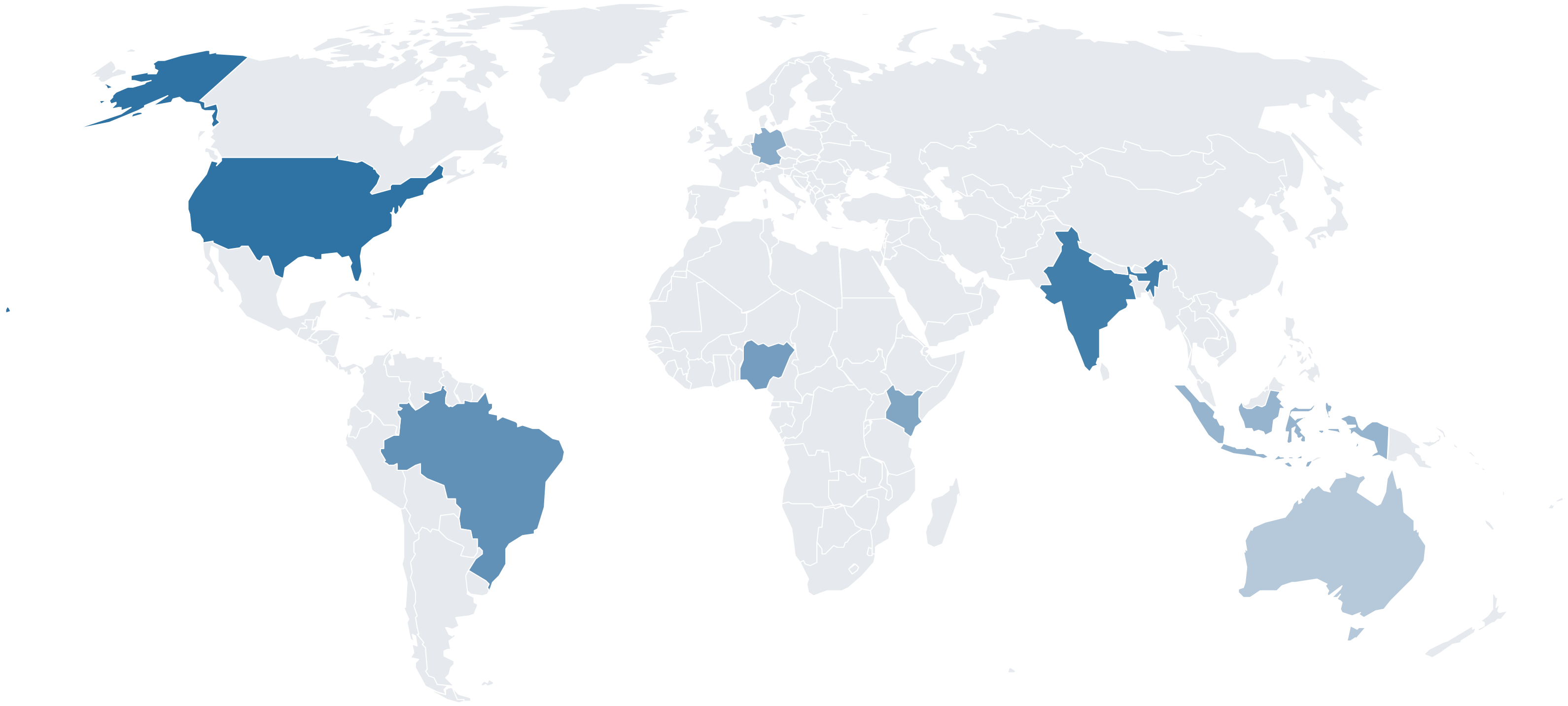
Germany	42.7
Japan	35.1
Canada	28.9
Australia	21.4
Chile	16.2
Morocco	12.8
Vietnam	10.5
Iceland	7.3

highlight fills by category, not value.



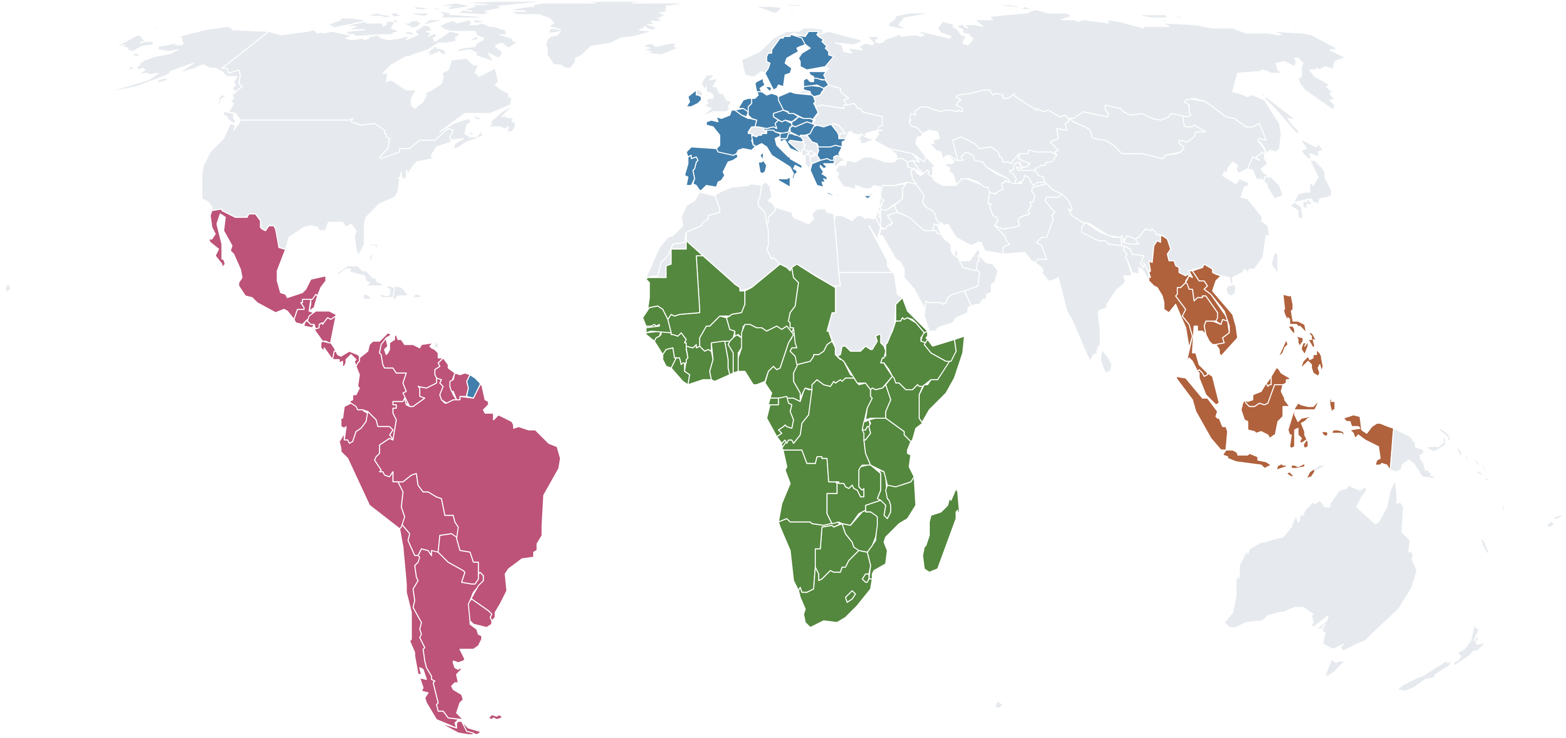
Kenya	East Africa
Nigeria	West Africa
India	South Asia
Brazil	Latin America

robinson swaps the projection.



United States	42
India	38
Brazil	31
Nigeria	27
Kenya	24
Germany	22
Indonesia	19
Australia	12

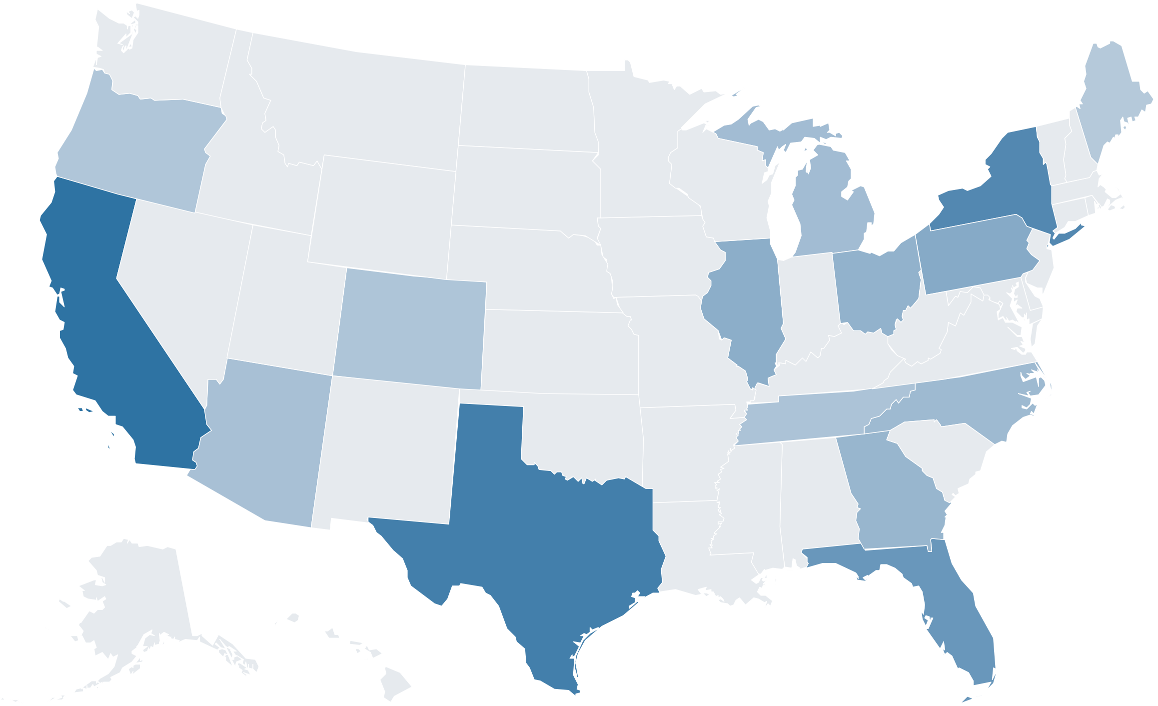
grouped fills whole blocs at once.



Groups

European Union	Tier 1
ASEAN	Tier 1
Sub-Saharan Africa	Tier 2
Latin America	Tier 2

A wide spread across fifteen states.



California	512
Texas	438
New York	390
Florida	301
Pennsylvania	188
Illinois	164
Ohio	142
Georgia	121
North Carolina	98
Michigan	76
Arizona	54
Tennessee	41
Colorado	33
Oregon	22
Maine	9

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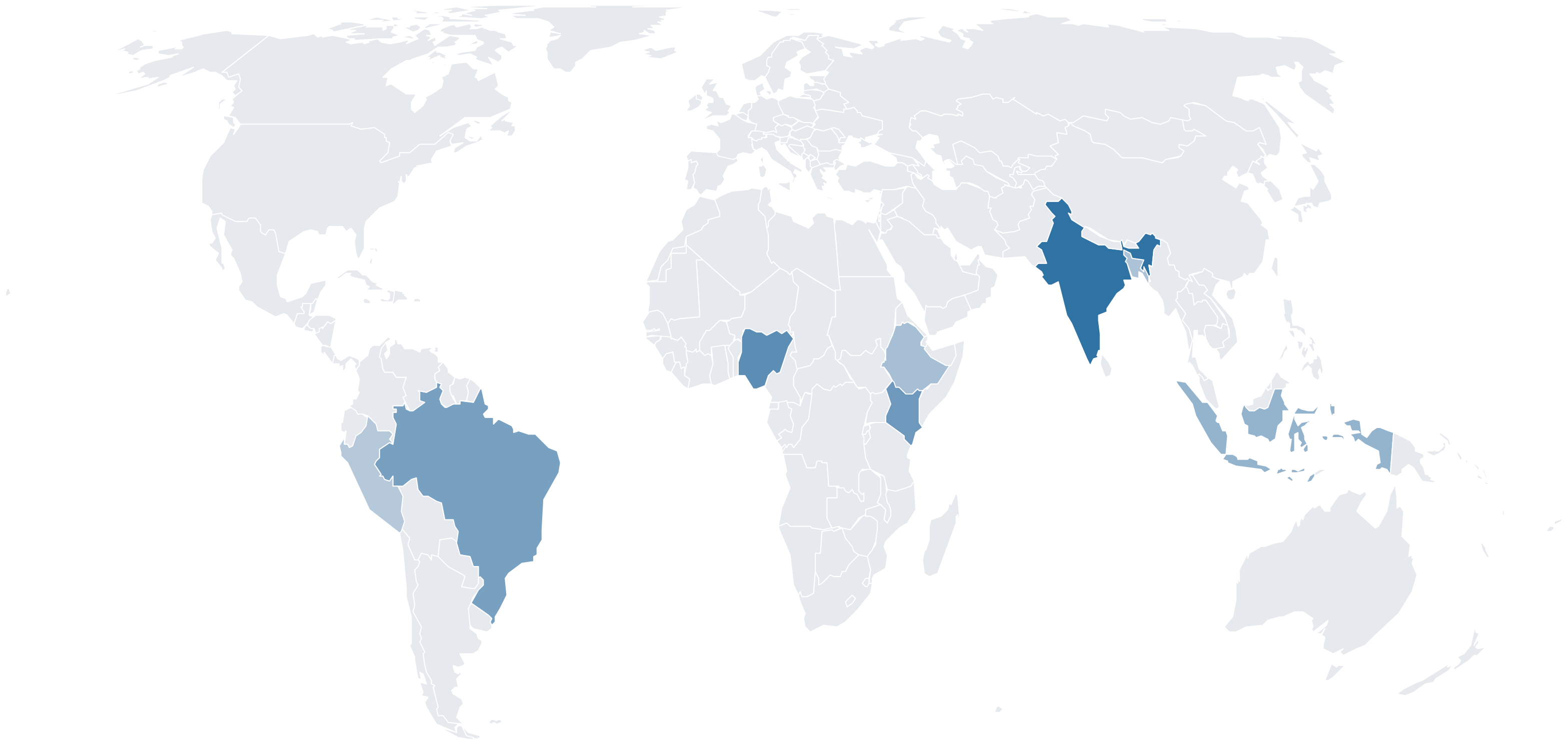

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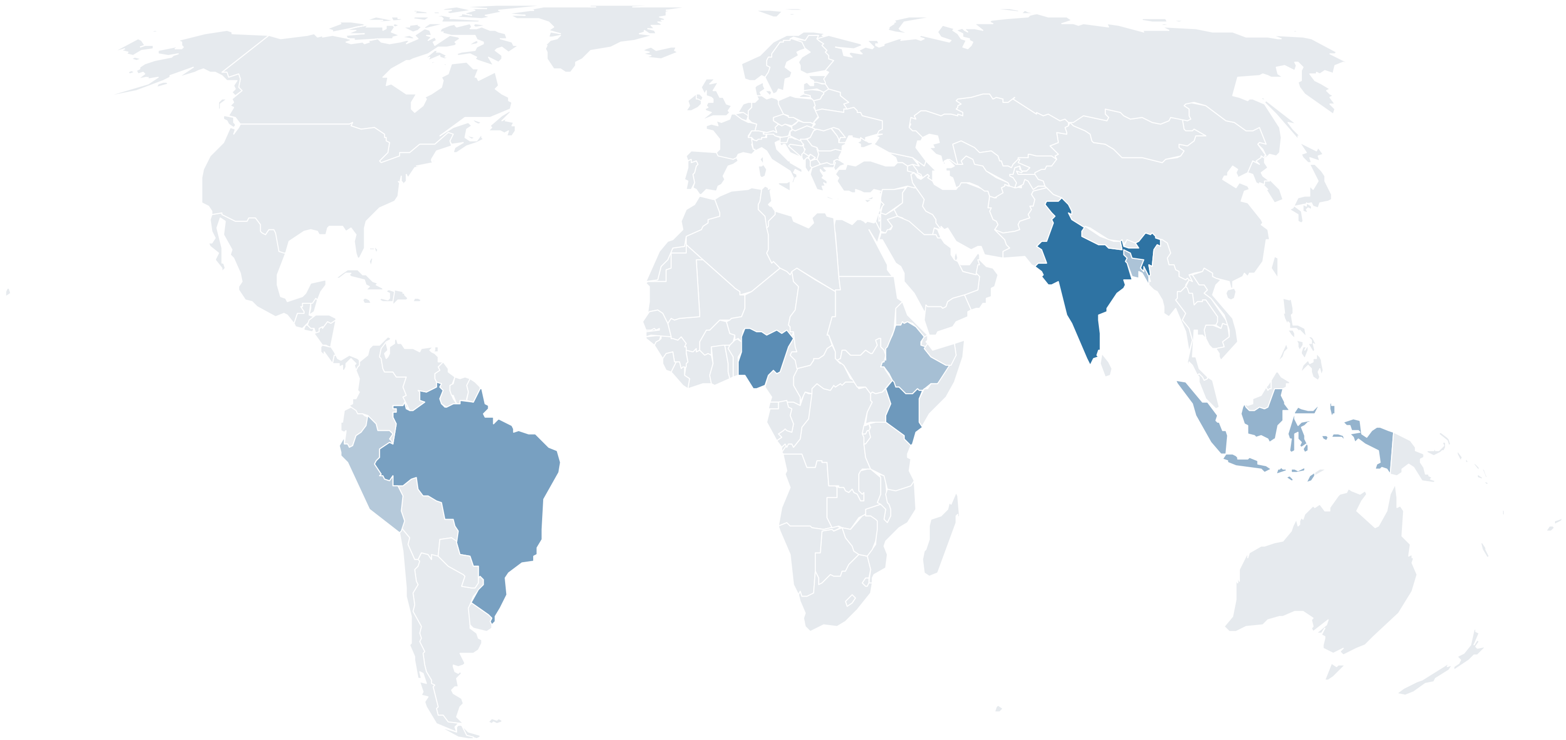

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When NOT to reach for map.

A map as decoration

If the regions aren't the comparison — you just want a US-shaped graphic behind some numbers — drop the basemap. An `image` scrim or a `stats` row carries headline figures without implying the geography is the message.

Too many shades to read

A choropleth past a dozen distinct values asks the eye to rank colors it can't separate. Bucket the values, switch to `highlight` for a categorical read, or lead with a `progress` ranking and keep the map as support.

Sub-region precision the basemap doesn't have

The basemaps draw US states and world countries — not counties, districts, sub-national regions, or city pins, and the world cut (110m) omits the smallest city-states. If the story lives below that line, a labeled `image` of the real map serves better than forcing it onto the basemap.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`progress` — the regions are really a ranking — labeled bars compare magnitudes faster than shades

`stats` — a few headline figures with no geography to place them on

`piechart` — regional shares of a single whole rather than a value per place

`image` — the geography needs detail (counties, cities, routes) the basemap can't draw